



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

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— Tantravārttika, (Chapter 10) Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

This passage from the Tantravārttika delves into the nature of action, duty, and the pursuit of truth, offering insights relevant to both ritualistic practices and the everyday choices you make. It speaks of Prajapati, the lord of creation, observing a vow, suggesting a focused and disciplined approach to actions. The text highlights that because of this disciplined state, certain observations or actions are deemed inappropriate. This isn't a blanket negation but rather a "paryudasa," a restrictive negation that ultimately reveals a positive injunction or truth. So, what appears as a prohibition actually points towards a more refined understanding and a more appropriate course of action.

The passage then contrasts two types of actions: those performed for personal gain ("svārtha") and those connected to ritualistic duties ("kratu-samyukta-puruṣārtha"). The former, driven by individual desires, are readily available to everyone. But the latter, actions interwoven with sacred rituals, produce different fruits ("phalantare"). This implies that actions performed with a sense of sacred duty, transcending purely personal motivations, lead to transformative results that extend beyond immediate gratification.

In modern life, you can apply this wisdom by reflecting on the intentions behind your actions. Are you driven solely by personal gain, or are you acting with a sense of purpose that connects you to something larger than yourself? Consider how you approach your work, your relationships, and even your daily routines. Can you infuse them with a sense of sacred duty, aligning your actions with higher values? When faced with restrictions or limitations, try to see them not as roadblocks, but as opportunities to refine your understanding and find a more authentic path. Recognizing the difference between self-serving actions and those performed with a sense of Dharma, of cosmic duty, will guide you towards a life of deeper meaning and fulfillment. It encourages you to move beyond self-centeredness, embracing a more holistic vision of your role in the world.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you truly aware of the motivations driving your daily actions, and how can you consciously align them with a higher purpose?